# Supplier Payment Control

Functional guide (user manual)

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## Contents

**Reading guide** ..... 3
- Who are you? ..... 3
- How to read this guide ..... 3

**Overview** ..... 4
- What the module does ..... 4
- The problem it solves ..... 4
- When to use it (and when not to) ..... 4

**Business cycle** ..... 5
- User stories ..... 5
- Step 1: Set the approval thresholds ..... 5
- Step 2: Mark shareholders and payroll accounts ..... 6
- Step 3: Check that the bill is cleared to pay ..... 8
- Step 4: Register the payment ..... 9
- Step 5: Approve the payment ..... 11
- Step 6: Confirm the payment ..... 12
- Step 7: Higher amounts go through several approvers ..... 13
- Step 8: Follow the payments waiting for approval ..... 14
- Step 9: Release a blocked duplicate ..... 16

**Conditional behavior** ..... 20
- Should Be Paid decides whether a bill can be paid ..... 20
- The approval status decides which buttons you see ..... 21
- A blocked duplicate shows a banner, and only the administrator can release it ..... 22
- Thresholds set to 0 switch a level off ..... 23
- Destination Account and the Approvals tab need the Bookkeeper group ..... 23

**Troubleshooting** ..... 24
- "These bills cannot be paid because they are not matched to their purchase order and receipt (Should Be Paid is not Yes): ..." ..... 24
- "... cannot be validated: these bills are not cleared to pay (Should Be Paid is not Yes): ..." ..... 24

"... cannot be posted before these approvals: ..." ..... 24
"This payment waits for the ...'s approval, which you cannot give." ..... 24
"... repeats ... (same vendor, amount and reference). It is blocked until an administrator releases it." .. 24
"Only an administrator can release a duplicate payment." ..... 25
"... is a payroll expense account: a payment to shareholder ... cannot be posted to it. Post it to the shareholder's account instead." ..... 25
"The bank account ... of ... is not trusted. Verify it with the vendor and mark it trusted before paying it." ..... 25
"Approval thresholds cannot be negative." / "Each approval threshold must be above the one of the level before it." ..... 26
A Finance Manager cannot see Payment Approvals, the Approvals tab or the Destination Account ..... 26
What this guide does not cover ..... 26

# Reading guide

## Who are you?

| You are… | What you do with this module | Read these chapters |
|---|---|---|
| **Accountant** (group Accounting / Bookkeeper, technical `account.group_account_user`; called Show Full Accounting Features and hidden from the user form when the Accounting app is not installed) | Register payments of vendor bills, prepare vendor payments, follow their approval status | Business cycle steps 3 to 6 and 8, Troubleshooting |
| **Finance Manager** (group Accounting / Administrator) | Give the first approval level, release bills in exception | Business cycle steps 3 to 7, Conditional behavior |
| **Operations Manager** (group Vendor Payment Approval / Payment approver (Operations)) | Give the second approval level | Business cycle step 7 |
| **Chief Executive** (group Vendor Payment Approval / Payment approver (Chief Executive)) | Give the third approval level | Business cycle step 7 |
| **Administrator** (group Administration / Settings) | Set the approval thresholds, release blocked duplicates | Business cycle steps 1, 2 and 9 |

## How to read this guide

Each step shows a screenshot. Red numbers on the screenshot, like 1, match the numbers in the text. Menu paths look like **Invoicing › Vendors › Payments**. Each chapter can be read on its own.

The screenshots come from a demonstration database where the full **Accounting** app is not installed, so the top menu reads Invoicing. With the Accounting app installed, read Accounting instead; the menus underneath are the same.

# Overview

## What the module does

Supplier Payment Control checks every payment that leaves the company towards a vendor:

- A vendor bill can be paid only when it matches its purchase order and its receipt (the bill's **Should Be Paid** field is Yes). Service bills raised without a purchase order are exempt.
- A vendor payment above the company's thresholds waits for one approval per level: the Finance Manager, then also the Operations Manager, then also the Chief Executive. Who approved, and when, is kept on the payment.
- A payment that repeats an earlier one (same vendor, amount and reference) is blocked until an administrator releases it.
- A payment to a bank account that is not trusted is refused, and a payment to a shareholder can never be posted to a payroll expense account.

## The problem it solves

Without it, anyone with accounting rights can pay a bill for goods that never arrived, pay a large amount without anyone senior seeing it, pay the same invoice twice, or book a shareholder's money as salary. The module turns each of these into a rule Odoo enforces, with a trace of who decided what.

## When to use it (and when not to)

Use it when vendor payments must follow an approval matrix by amount and only matched bills may be paid. Customer payments and money received are not affected at all. The module does not schedule payment runs, keep standing bank instructions or pay recurring bills automatically.

# Business cycle

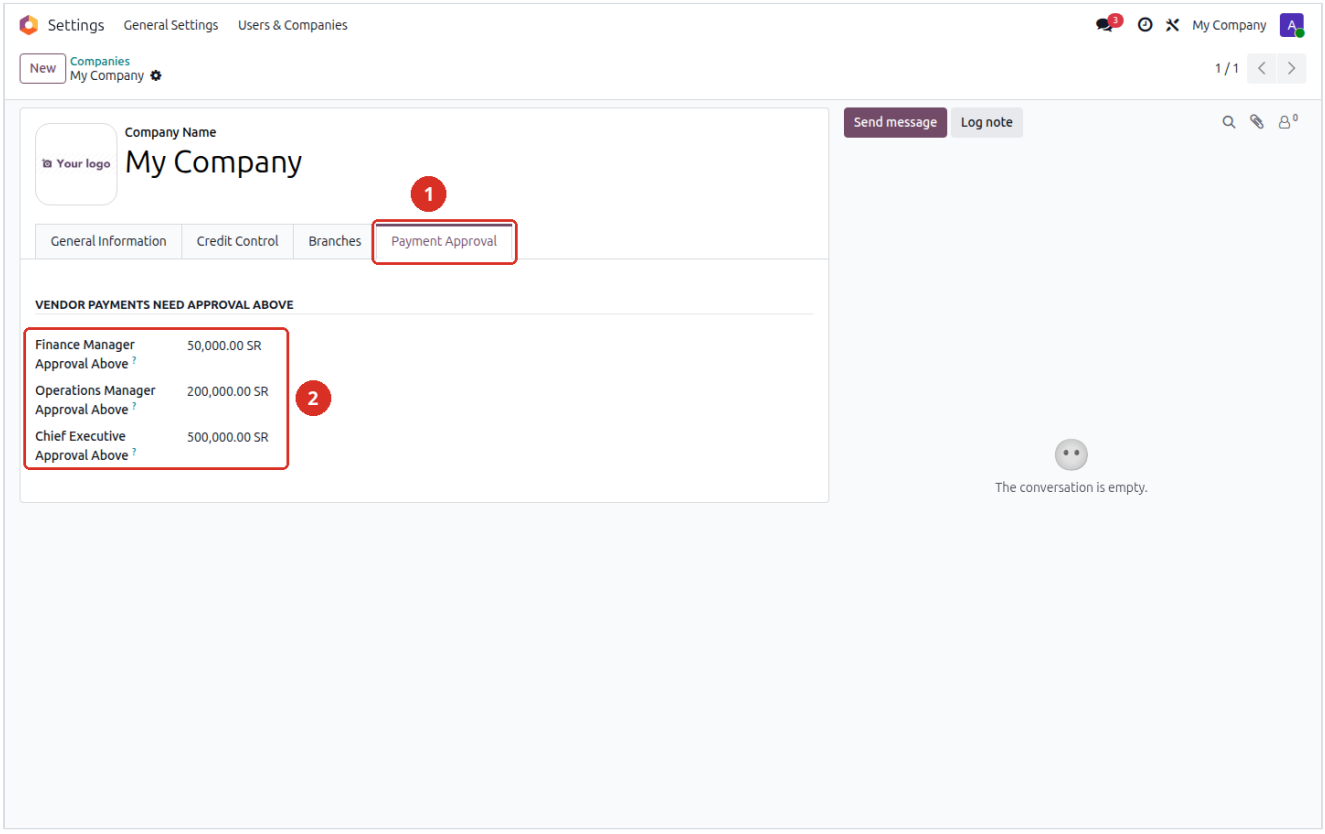
## User stories

- As an **accountant**, I want Odoo to refuse paying a bill that does not match its order and receipt, so that we never pay for goods we did not receive.
- As a **Finance Manager**, I want large vendor payments to wait for my approval, so that no large amount leaves without my review.
- As a **Chief Executive**, I want to approve the very large payments myself, after Finance and Operations, so that the biggest commitments come to me last and complete.
- As an **administrator**, I want a repeated payment to stop until I look at it, so that an invoice is never paid twice by mistake.

## Step 1: Set the approval thresholds

**Who:** the administrator, once per company. Go to **Settings › Users & Companies › Companies** and open the company.

1. Open the **Payment Approval** tab 1.
2. Fill in the three amounts 2: **Finance Manager Approval Above**, **Operations Manager Approval Above**, **Chief Executive Approval Above**. Amounts are in the company currency.
3. Save.



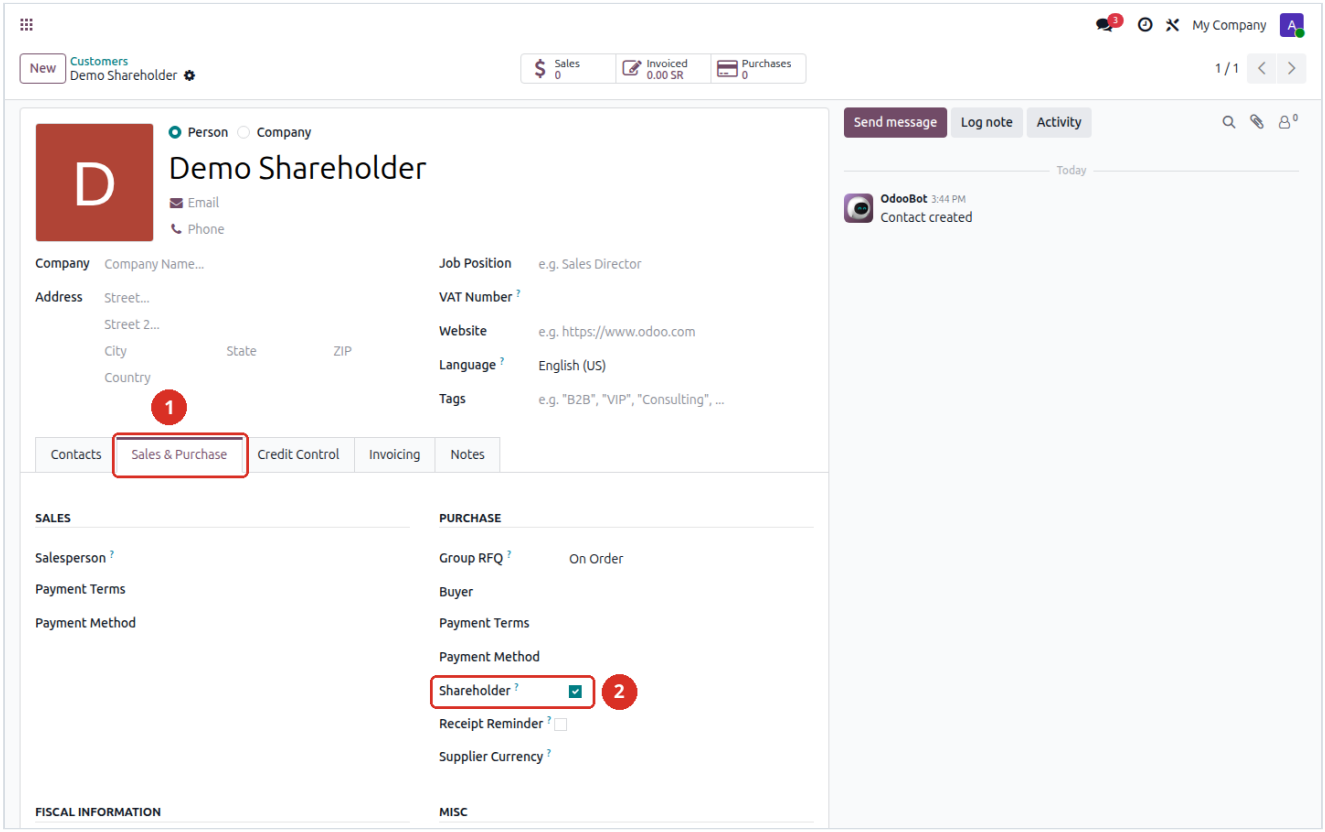

The company's Payment Approval tab 1 and the three thresholds 2 (sample values 50,000 / 200,000 / 500,000 SAR).

With the sample values above, a payment of 30,000 SAR needs no approval, 120,000 SAR needs the Finance Manager, 300,000 SAR needs Finance and Operations, and 650,000 SAR needs all three. An amount exactly equal to a threshold does not need that level. A threshold left at 0 switches its level off: **until the thresholds are set, no payment needs approval**.

## Step 2: Mark shareholders and payroll accounts

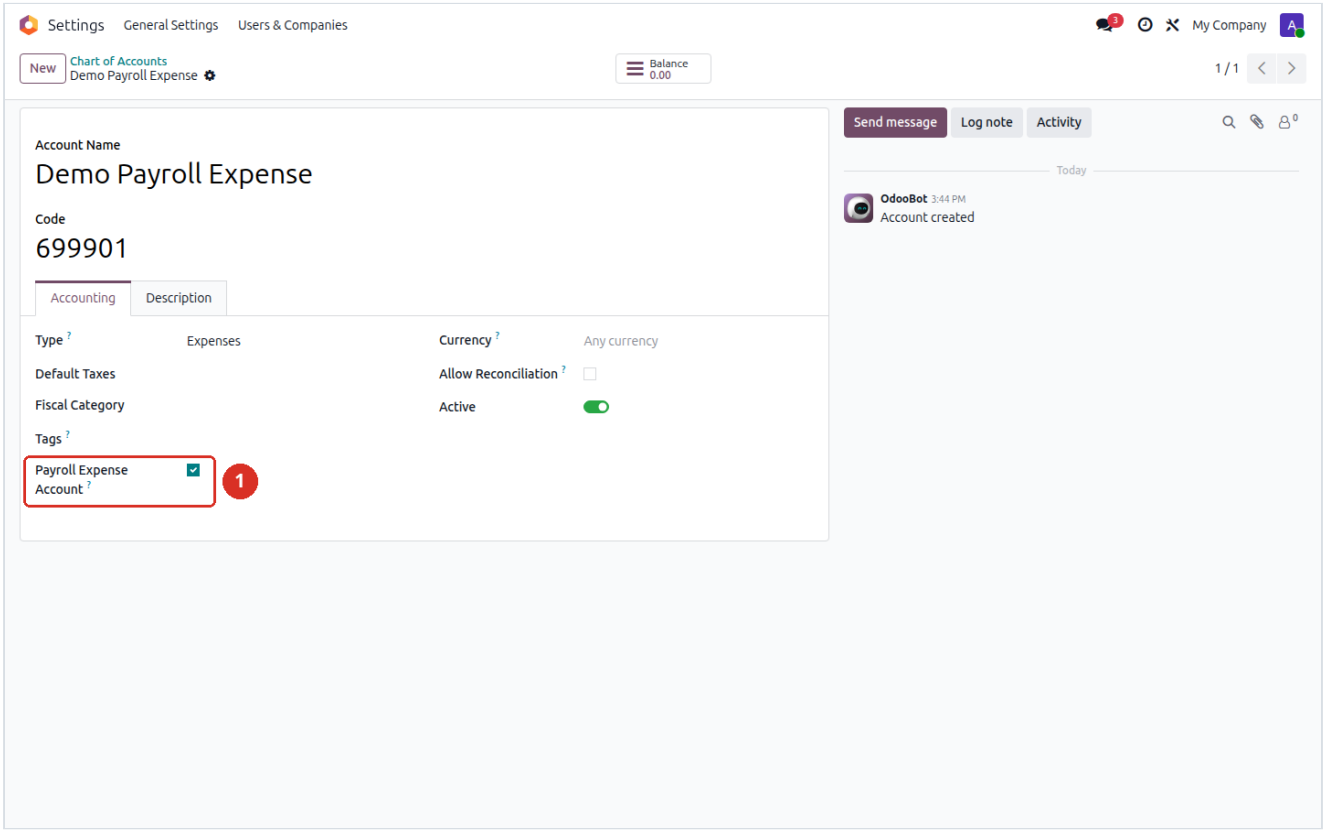
**Who:** the administrator or the Finance Manager, once.

1. Open each shareholder's contact, tab **Sales & Purchase** 1, and tick **Shareholder** 2.




A contact's Sales & Purchase tab 1 with the Shareholder box 2.

1. Open each salary or payroll expense account in the chart of accounts and tick **Payroll Expense Account** 1.



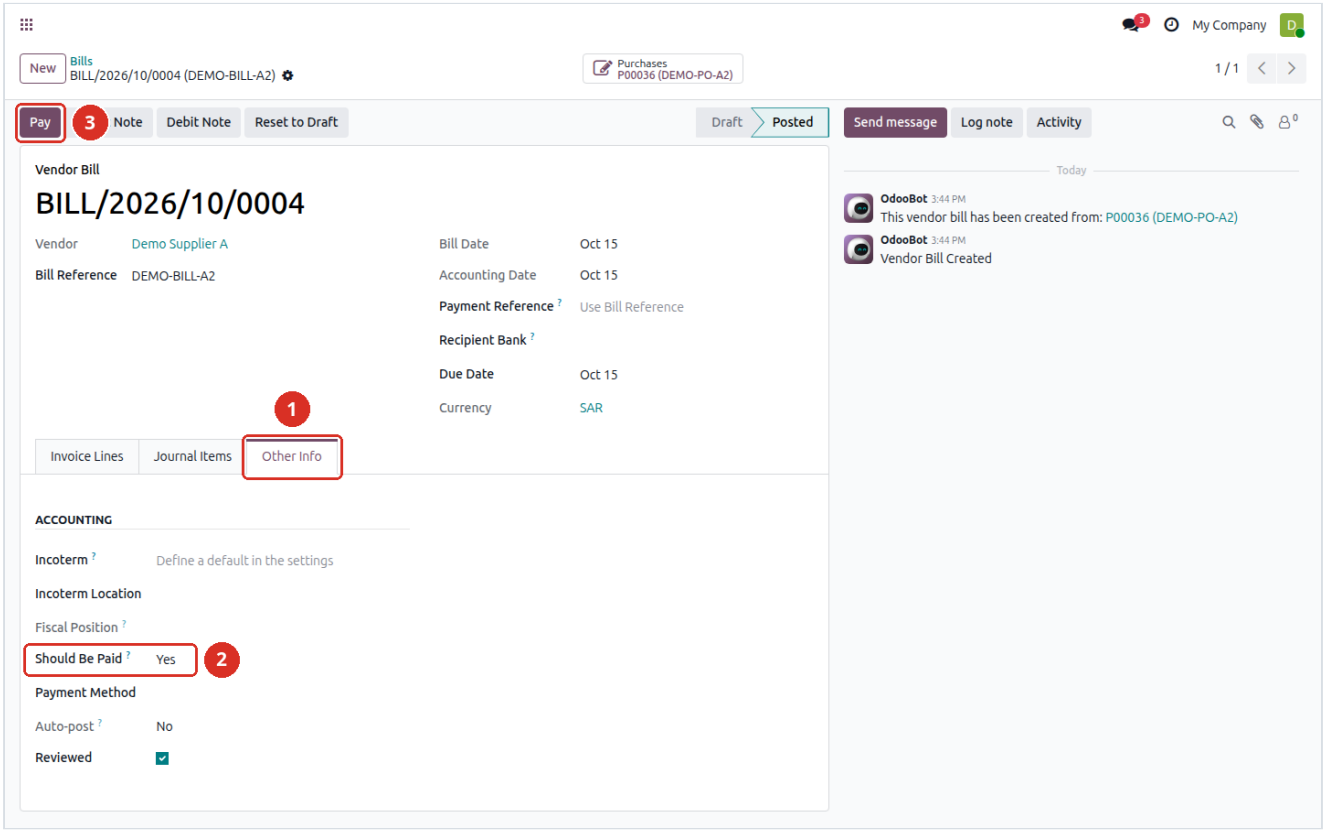

An expense account with Payroll Expense Account ticked 1.

Also make sure each vendor bank account you pay to is marked **Trusted** in standard Odoo; a payment to an untrusted account is refused.

## Step 3: Check that the bill is cleared to pay

**Who:** the accountant. Go to **Invoicing › Vendors › Bills** and open the bill.

1. Open the **Other Info** tab 1.
2. Read **Should Be Paid** 2. Yes means the billed quantities match what was ordered and received.
3. If it says Yes, click **Pay** 3.



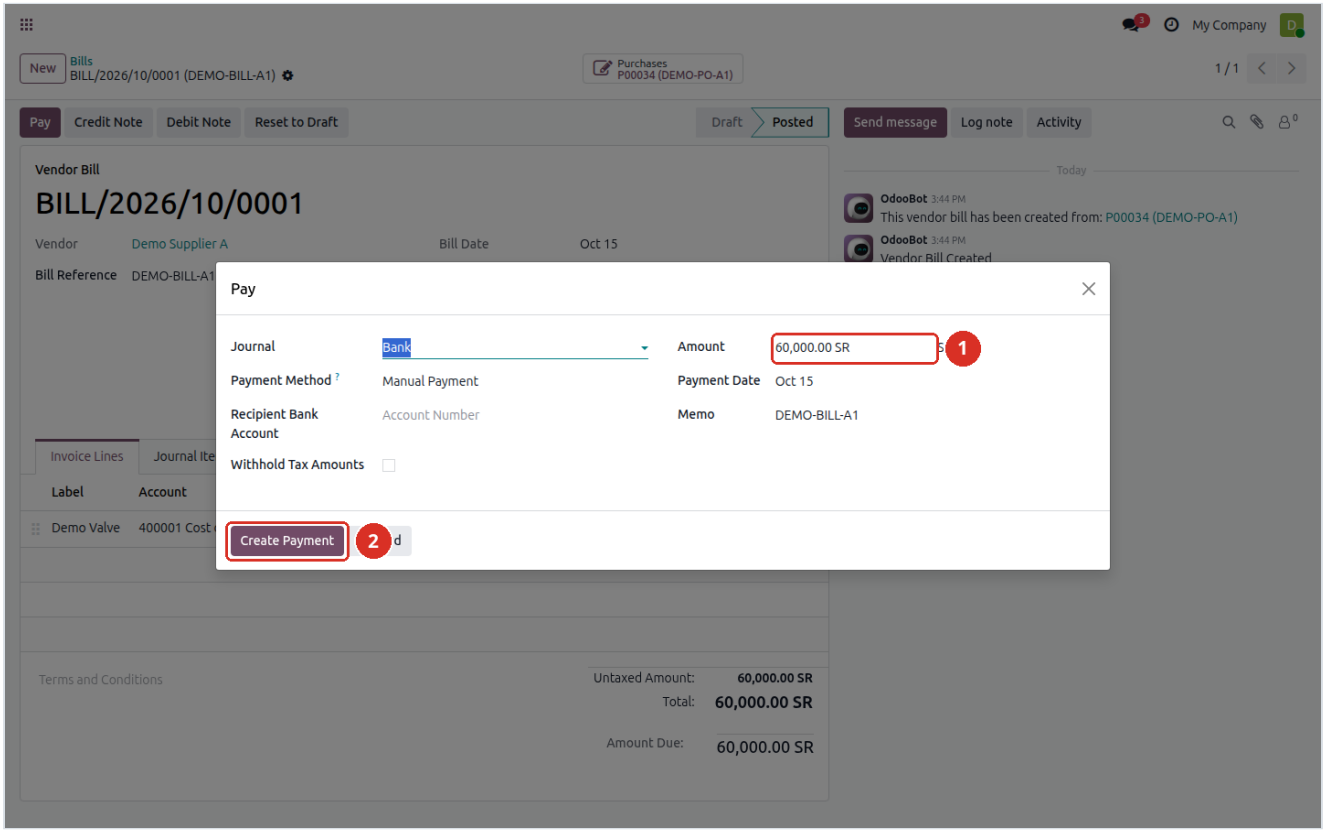

A vendor bill created from its purchase order: Other Info tab 1, Should Be Paid is Yes 2, the Pay button 3.

If **Should Be Paid** is No or Exception, Odoo refuses the payment (see Conditional behavior).

## Step 4: Register the payment

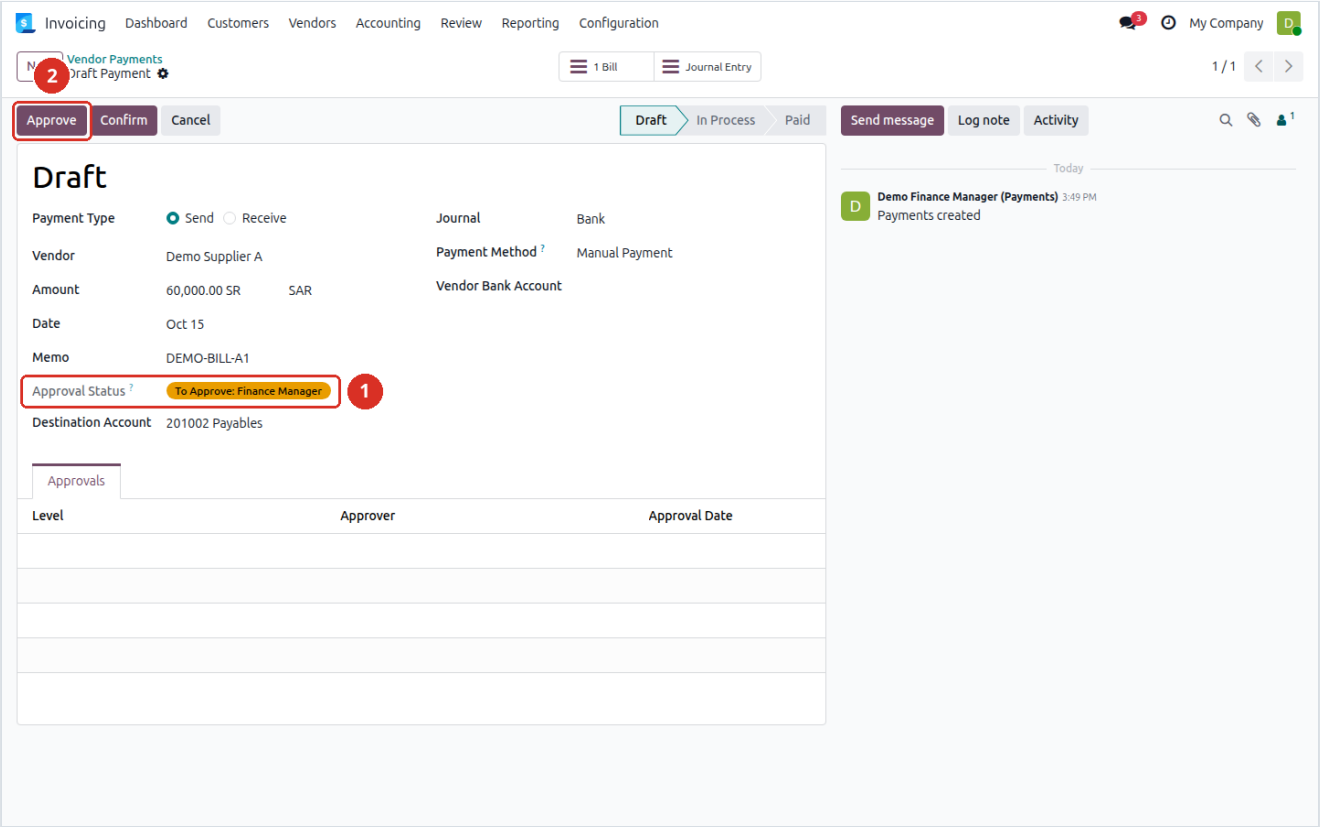
**Who:** the accountant. In the **Pay** window (a pop-up that asks how to pay):

1. Check the **Amount** 1, the journal and the date.
2. Click **Create Payment** 2.




The Pay window for a 60,000 SAR bill: the amount 1 and Create Payment 2.

**What you should see:** the bill stays not paid, and its new payment waits in **Draft**. Open it from the bill's **Payments** smart button (the button at the top of the bill) or from **Invoicing › Vendors › Payments**. Its **Approval Status** 1 says which level must approve next. The **Approve** button 2 is shown only to users who hold an approver group.



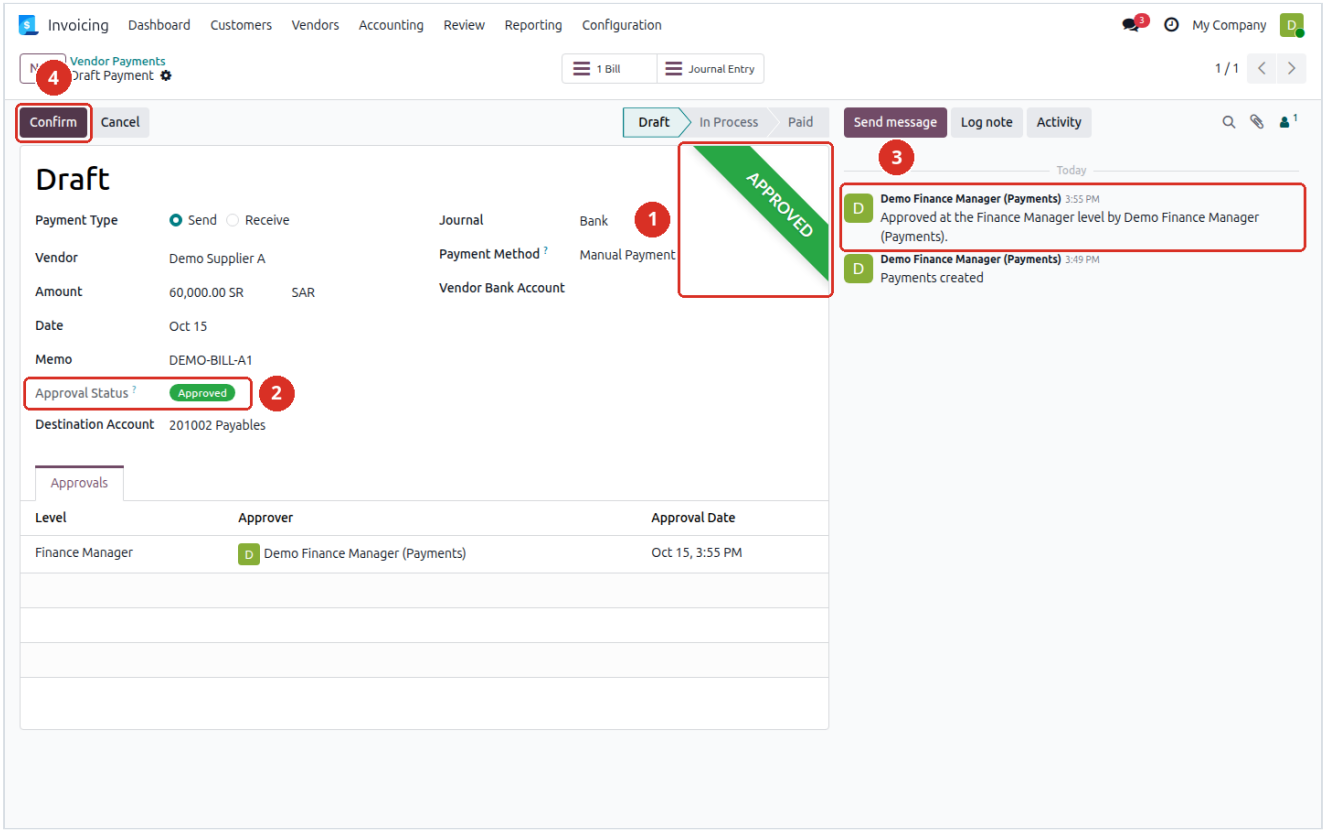

The 60,000 SAR payment, created from the bill, waits in Draft: Approval Status To Approve: Finance Manager 1, the Approve button 2.

A payment below the first threshold does not wait: it is posted straight away, as in standard Odoo.

## Step 5: Approve the payment

**Who:** the approver of the level shown in **Approval Status**. Open the payment and click **Approve**.

**What you should see:** an **APPROVED** ribbon 1 once every level the amount requires is given, the status **Approved** 2, a note in the chatter (the message history on the right) naming the approver 3, and a new line in the **Approvals** tab with the level, the approver and the date.



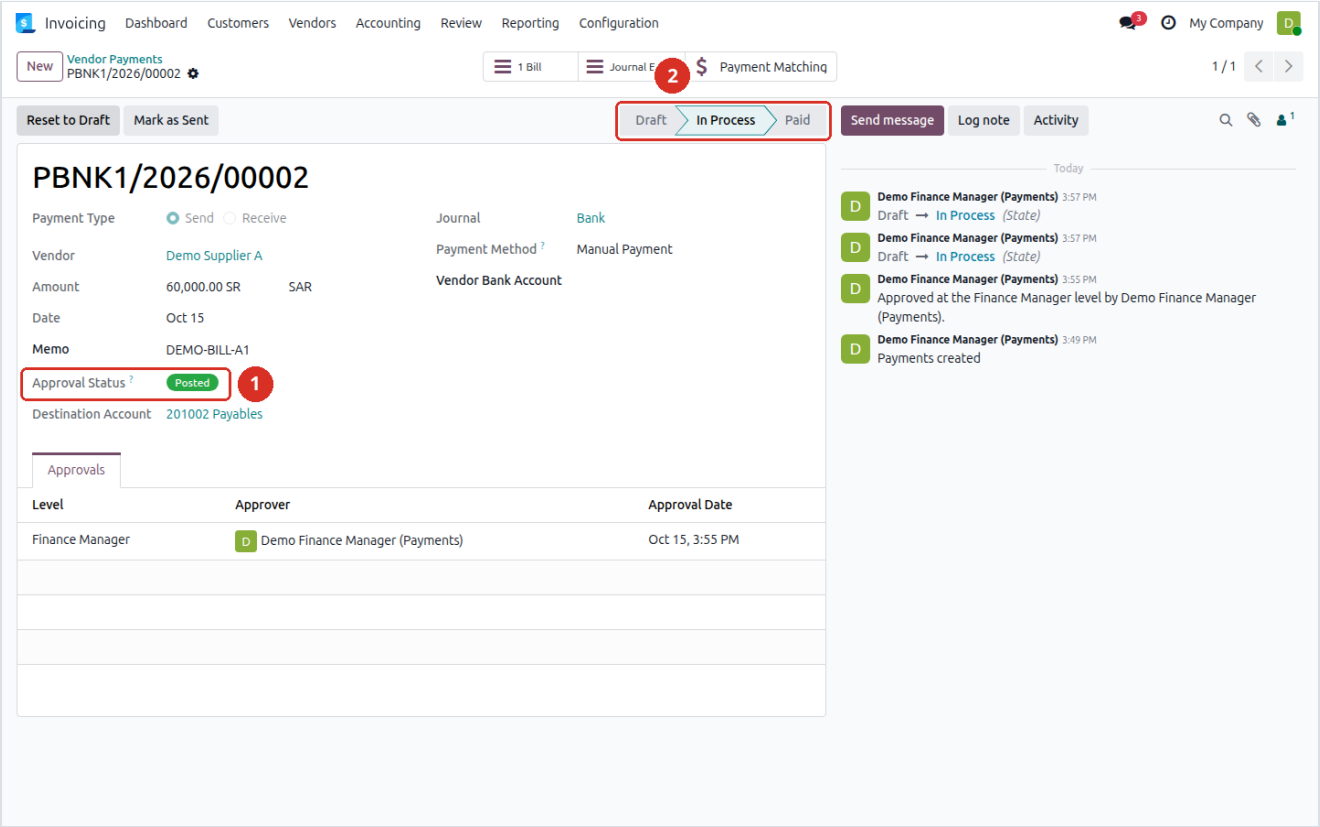

After the Finance Manager's approval: the APPROVED ribbon 1, the status 2, the chatter note 3, and Confirm 4.

Each click gives one level only, the next one in order. A user who holds several approver groups clicks once per level.

## Step 6: Confirm the payment

**Who:** the accountant or the approver. Click **Confirm** (4 on the previous screenshot).

**What you should see:** the payment gets its number, moves to **In Process** 2, and its **Approval Status** shows **Posted** 1. This is the end of the cycle for this payment: from here, the bank reconciliation is standard Odoo.



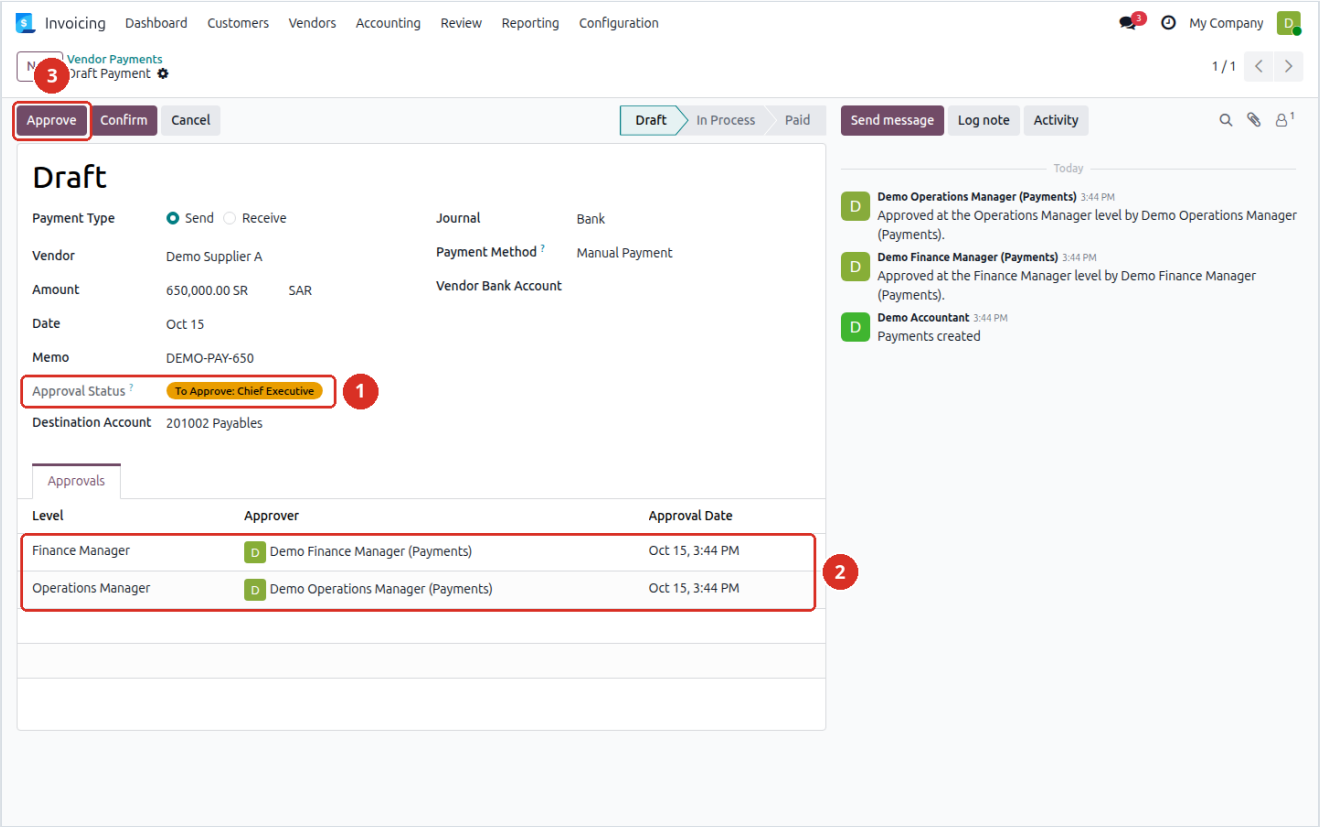

The confirmed payment: Approval Status Posted 1 and the status bar on In Process 2.

If you click **Confirm** before every level is approved, Odoo refuses and lists the missing levels (see Troubleshooting).

## Step 7: Higher amounts go through several approvers

**Who:** Finance Manager, then Operations Manager, then Chief Executive, in that order.

Payments above the second and third thresholds collect one approval per level. The status 1 always names the next level; the **Approvals** tab 2 lists those already given. The next approver opens the payment and clicks **Approve** 3; the button refuses a user who does not hold that level's group.

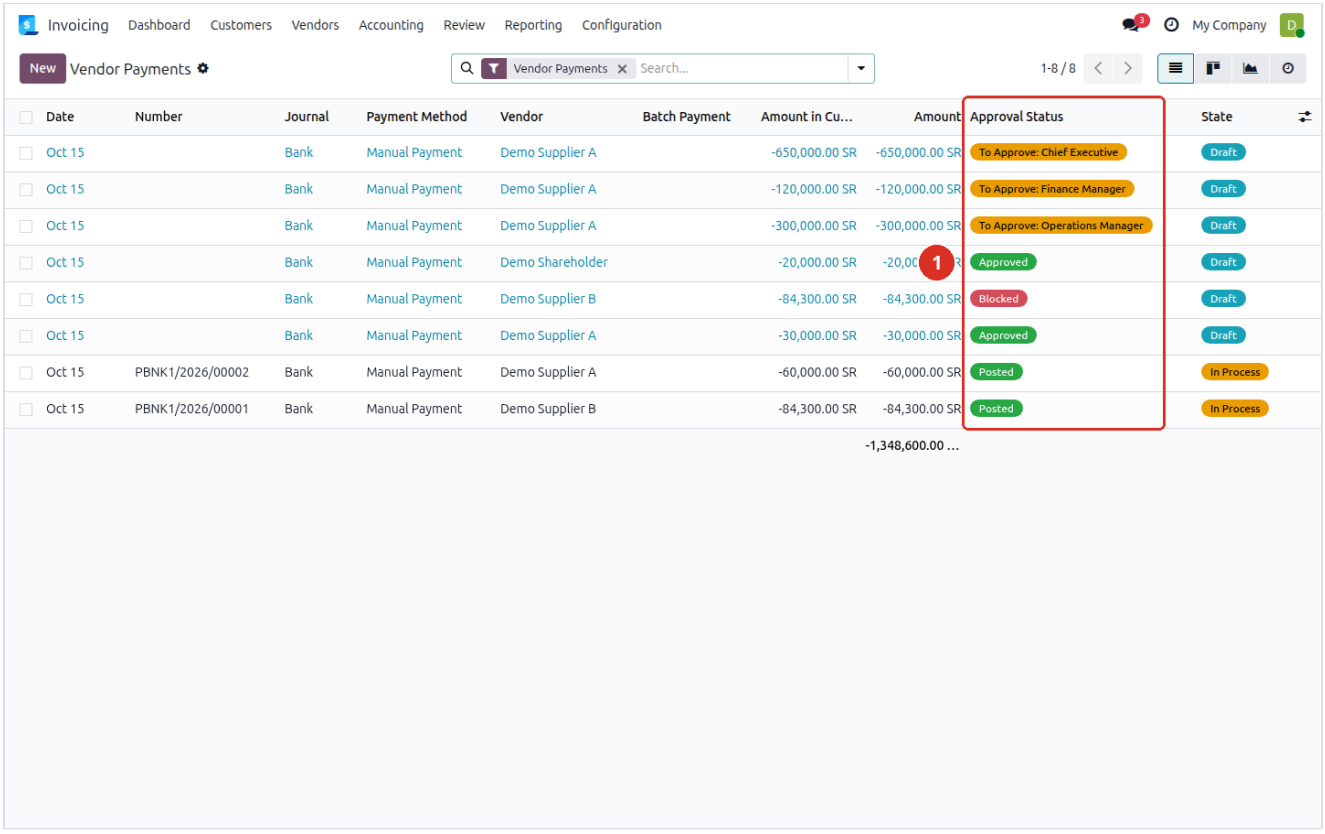



A 650,000 SAR payment approved by Finance and Operations, waiting for the Chief Executive 1; the two approvals given 2; Approve 3.

## Step 8: Follow the payments waiting for approval

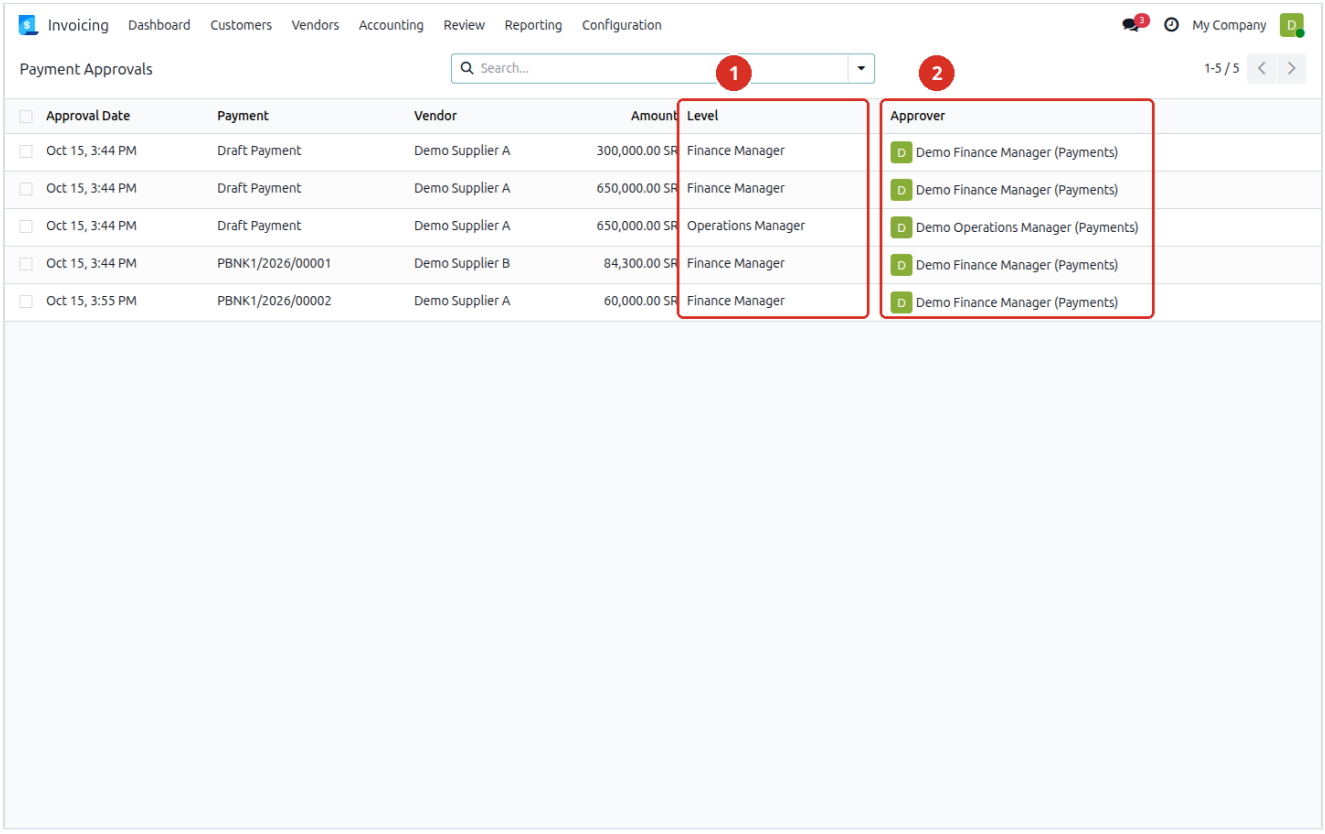
**Who:** anyone who approves or prepares payments.

The list of vendor payments, **Invoicing › Vendors › Payments**, has an **Approval Status** column 1. In the search bar, the filters **To Approve** and **Blocked Duplicates** narrow the list.




The vendor payments list with its Approval Status column 1: waiting payments in orange, blocked in red, approved and posted in green.

Every approval ever given is listed in **Invoicing › Vendors › Payment Approvals**, with the **Level** 1 and the **Approver** 2. You can group by level or approver. This list cannot be edited: an approval, once given, stays.




Payment Approvals: one line per approval, with its level 1 and approver 2.

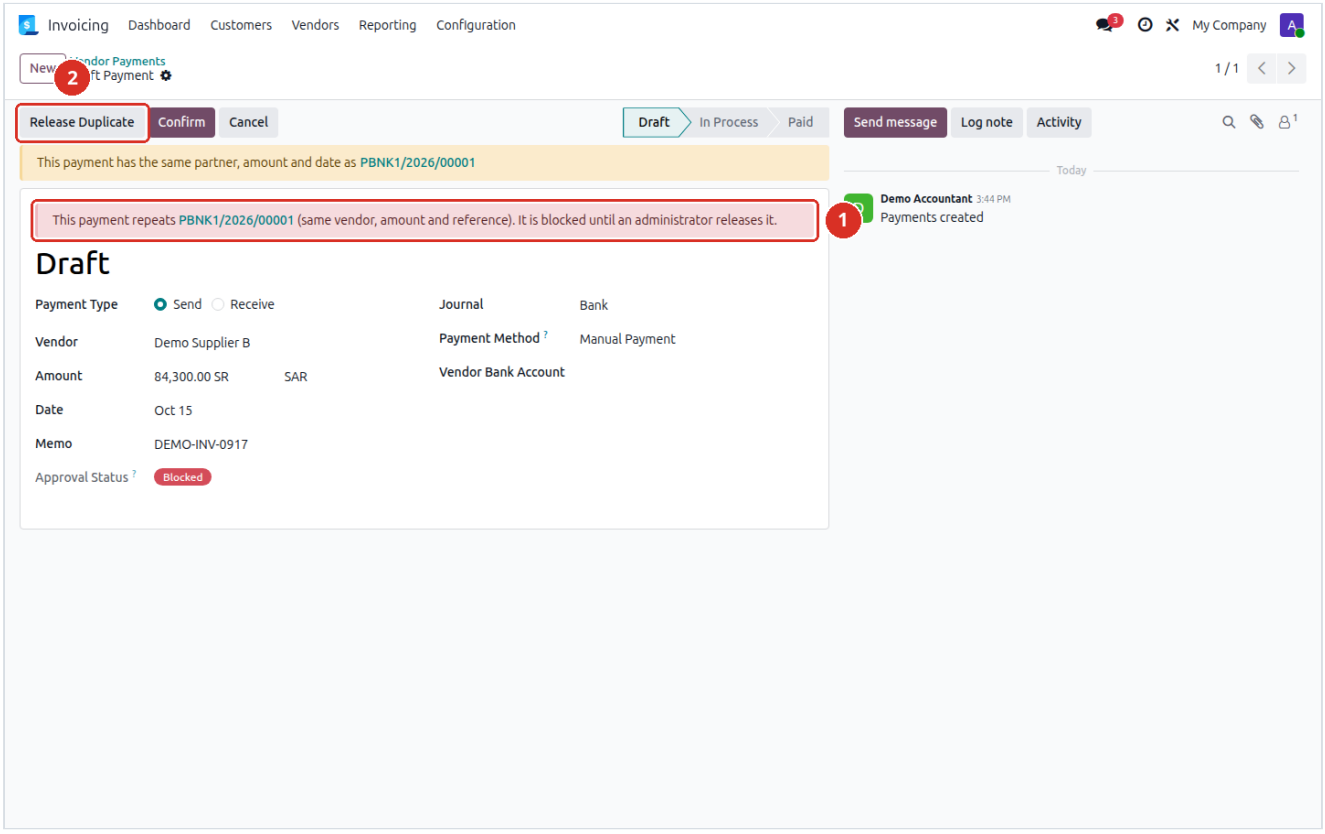
Payments that are still in draft have no number yet, so they appear as Draft Payment in the **Payment** column; use the vendor and amount to tell them apart.

## Step 9: Release a blocked duplicate

**Who:** the administrator only.

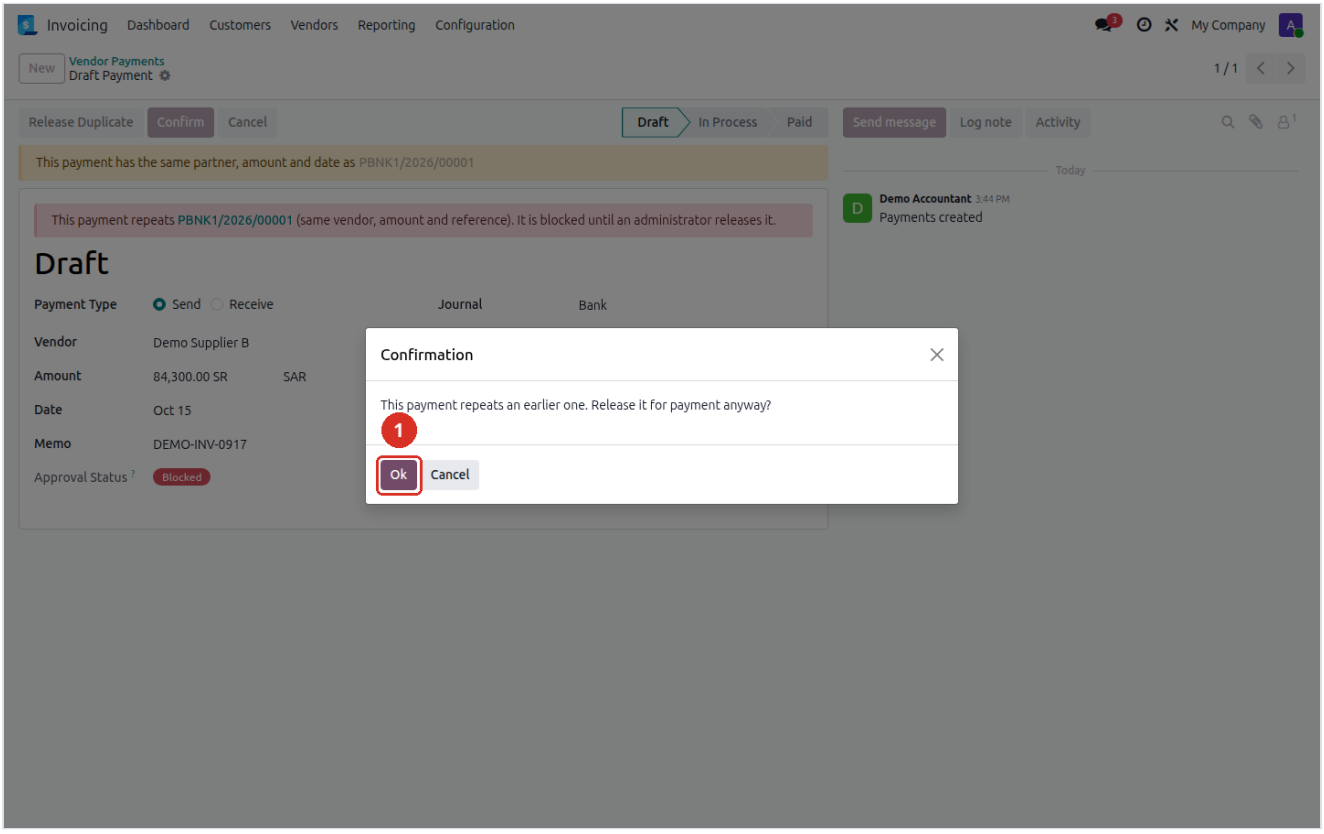
When a new vendor payment has the same vendor, amount and reference (memo) as an earlier one, it is **Blocked**. Other users see the red banner and cannot release it (see Conditional behavior). The administrator opens the payment:

1. Read the red banner 1: it links to the earlier payment. Check with the vendor and the accountant that paying again is right.
2. Click **Release Duplicate** 2.



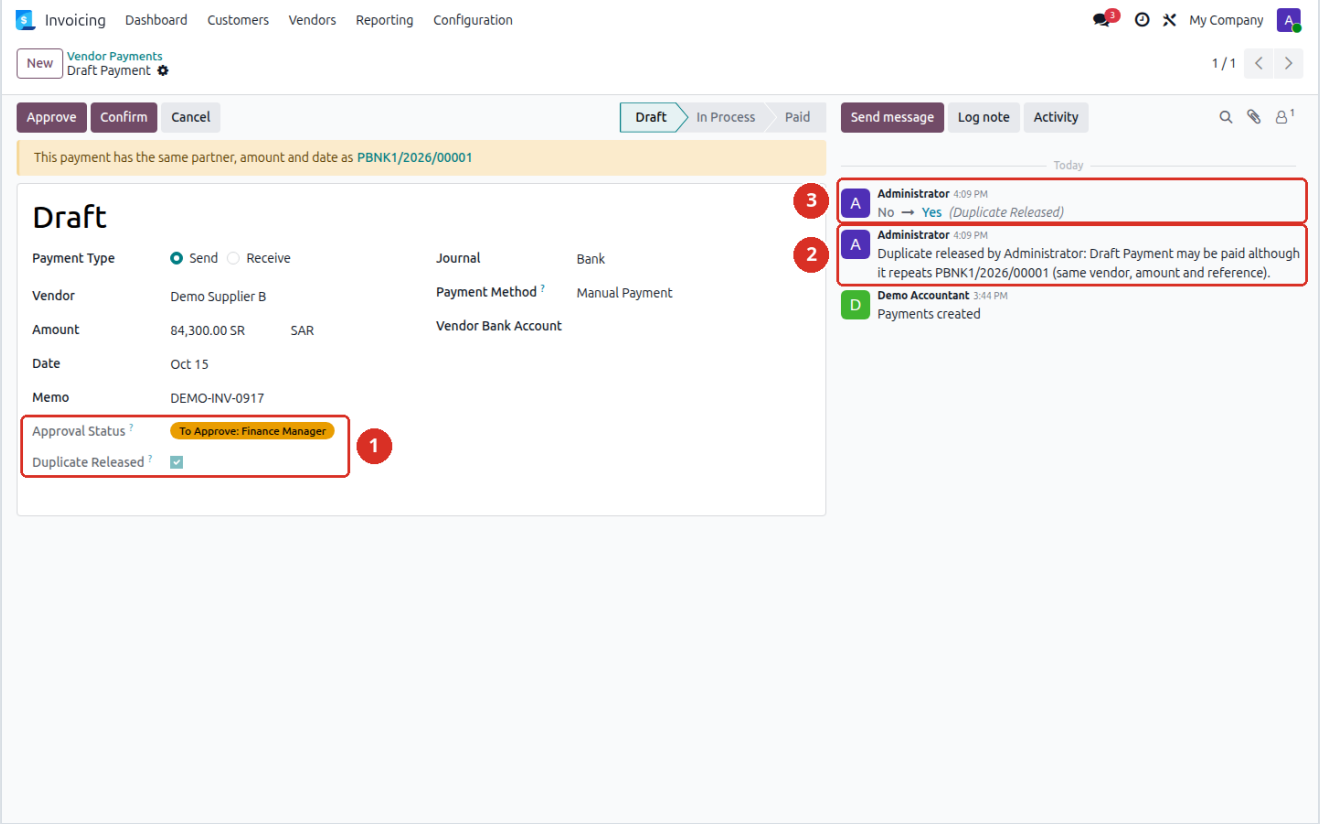

The blocked payment as the administrator sees it: the banner naming the earlier payment 1 and Release Duplicate 2.

1. Confirm with **Ok** 1.




The confirmation window: Ok 1.

**What you should see:** the banner disappears, **Duplicate Released** is ticked and the payment goes on to its normal approvals 1. The release is logged in the chatter 2 3, here and on the earlier payment. The earlier payment is not changed.



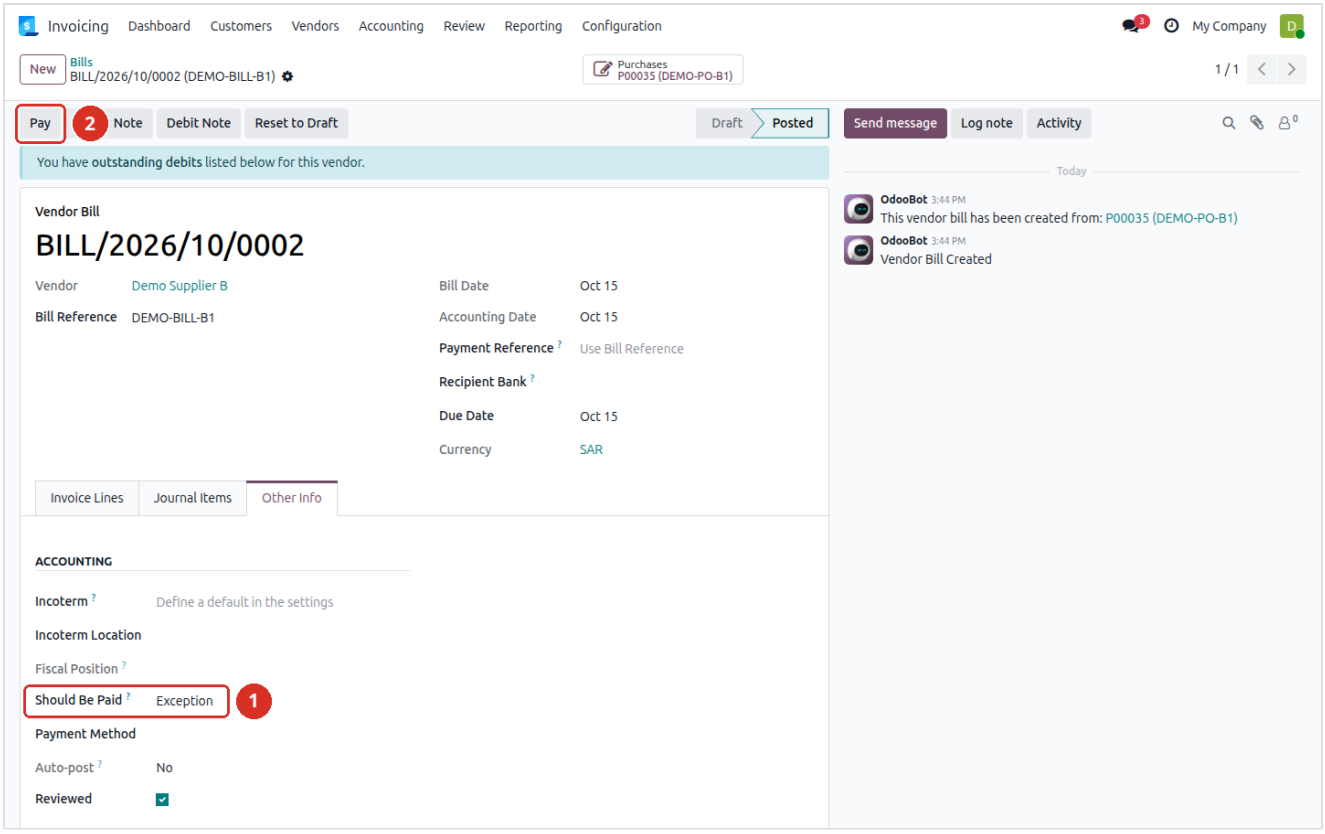

After the release: the payment now waits for the Finance Manager and Duplicate Released is ticked 1; the release note 2 and the field change 3 in the chatter.

# Conditional behavior

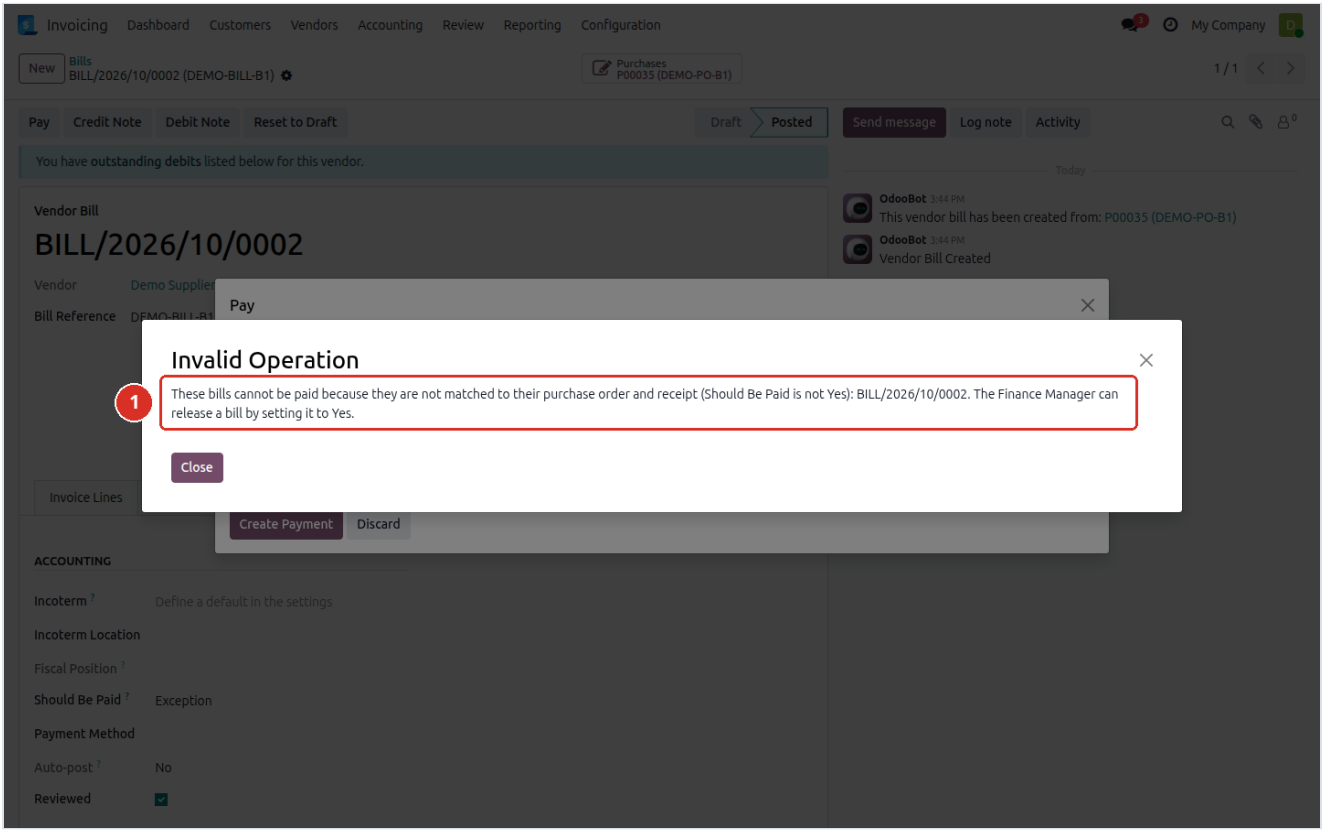
## Should Be Paid decides whether a bill can be paid

**When Should Be Paid is Yes:** the bill is paid as in Step 3.

**When Should Be Paid is No or Exception:** for example, 10 valves were billed but only 6 received. The bill shows Exception 1; clicking **Pay** 2 and then **Create Payment** is refused.




A bill billed above what was received: Should Be Paid is Exception 1; the Pay button 2.




The refusal names the bill 1.

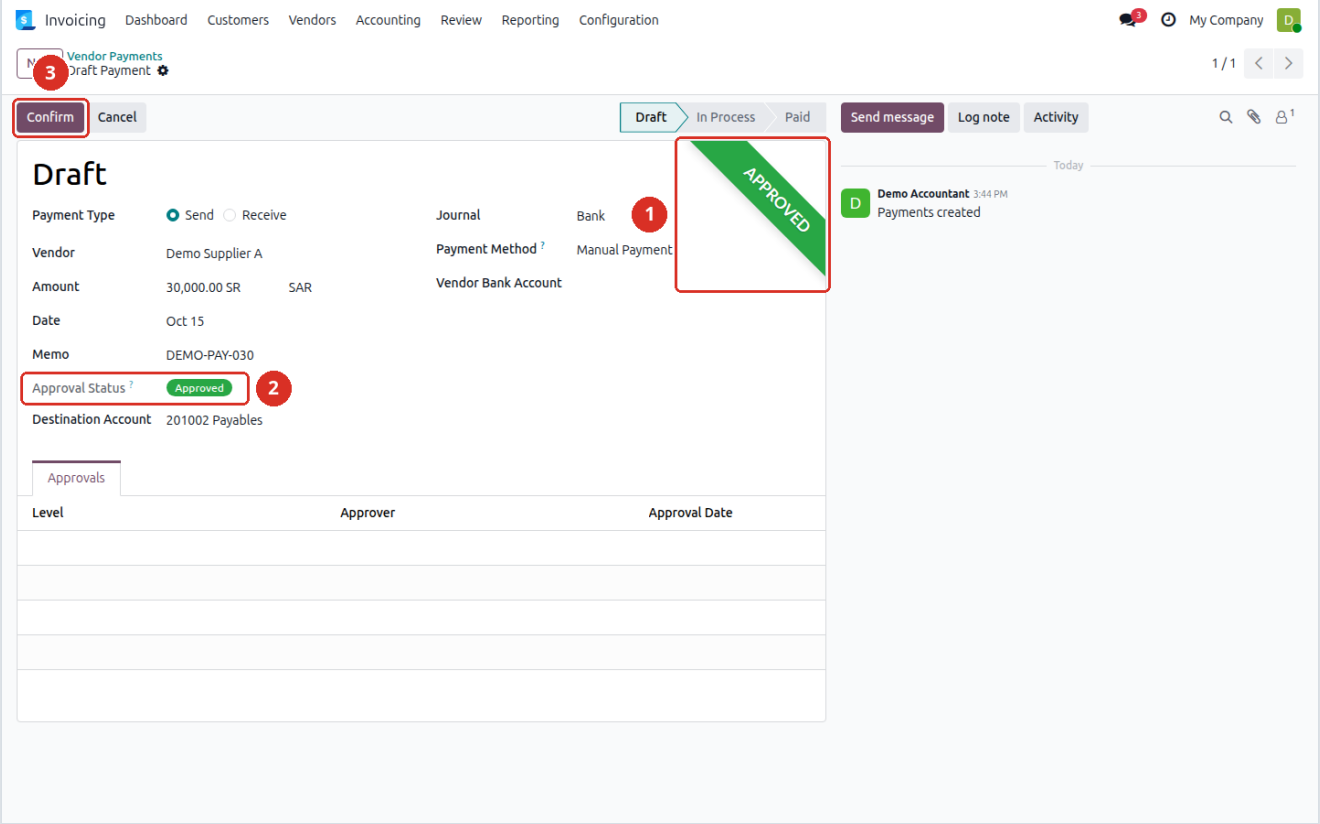
The same refusal applies when validating a batch payment that contains such a bill. The Finance Manager can set **Should Be Paid** to Yes by hand on the bill (Other Info tab) once the difference is explained; the bill is then paid through the normal approvals.

**Service bills without a purchase order** (every line is a service and none comes from a purchase order) are paid without this check.

## The approval status decides which buttons you see

**When the payment waits for approval:** the status is orange (To Approve: ...) and the **Approve** button is shown to approvers (see the screenshot in Step 4).

**When no approval is needed, or all are given:** the status is **Approved** 2, an **APPROVED** ribbon 1 is shown and only **Confirm** 3 remains. A payment below the first threshold shows this from the start, with an empty **Approvals** tab: Approved there means "nothing left to approve", not that someone signed it.

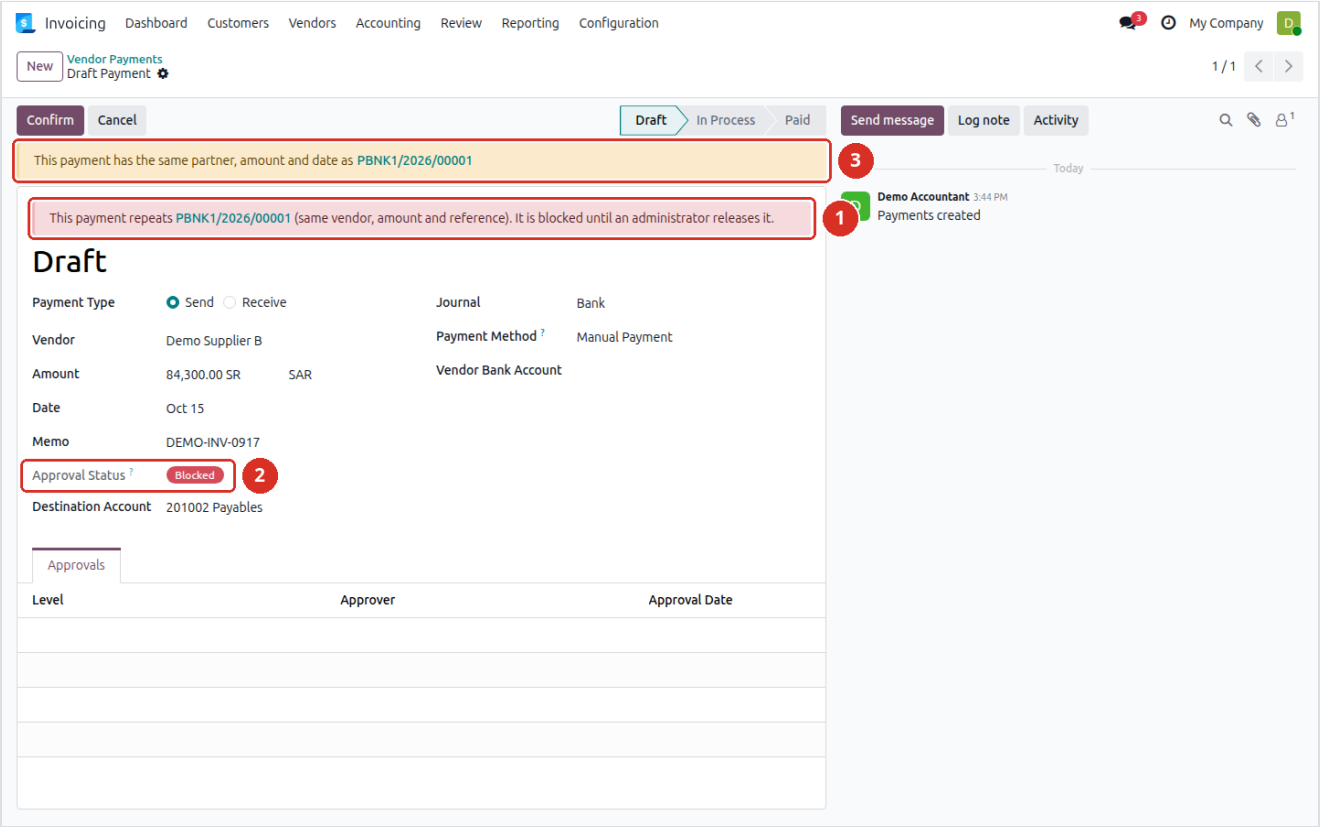



A 30,000 SAR payment below the first threshold: ribbon 1, status Approved 2, Confirm 3.

The **Approval Status**, the ribbon and the **Approvals** tab appear only on payments sent to vendors. Customer payments and money received look exactly as in standard Odoo.

## A blocked duplicate shows a banner, and only the administrator can release it

**When you are not an administrator:** the payment shows the red banner 1 and the status **Blocked** 2, with no **Approve** and no **Release Duplicate** button. Standard Odoo's yellow warning 3 may also appear; the red banner is the one that blocks.




A blocked duplicate seen by the Finance Manager: red banner 1, status Blocked 2, standard warning 3.

**When you are an administrator:** the **Release Duplicate** button is shown (see Step 9).

## Thresholds set to 0 switch a level off

Leaving a threshold at 0 means that level is never required. Leaving all three at 0 means no vendor payment needs approval. Set thresholds must rise from the first to the third.

## Destination Account and the Approvals tab need the Bookkeeper group

The **Destination Account** field (shown on payments sent out, and editable while in draft) and the **Approvals** tab are shown only to users in Accounting / Bookkeeper (and, for the tab, to the two approver groups). The same applies to the **Invoicing › Vendors › Payment Approvals** menu. See Troubleshooting if a Finance Manager cannot see them.

# Troubleshooting

## "These bills cannot be paid because they are not matched to their purchase order and receipt (Should Be Paid is not Yes): ..."

**What happened:** the bill's billed quantities do not match what was ordered and received.

**How to fix it:**

1. Open the bill, tab **Other Info**, and read **Should Be Paid**.
2. Receive the missing goods, or ask the vendor for a corrected bill or credit note.
3. If the difference is accepted, the Finance Manager sets **Should Be Paid** to Yes, then pay again.

## "... cannot be validated: these bills are not cleared to pay (Should Be Paid is not Yes): ..."

**What happened:** a batch payment to vendors contains a payment for a bill whose **Should Be Paid** is not Yes. The message names the batch and the bills.

**How to fix it:** remove that payment from the batch, or clear the bill as above, then validate again.

## "... cannot be posted before these approvals: ..."

**What happened:** you clicked **Confirm** on a payment whose amount needs approvals that are not all given. The message lists the missing levels.

**How to fix it:** ask the approvers listed to open the payment and click **Approve**, in order, then confirm.

## "This payment waits for the ...'s approval, which you cannot give."

**What happened:** you clicked **Approve**, but the next level belongs to another approver group.

**How to fix it:** ask the user who holds that level to approve. The administrator gives the groups: Accounting / Administrator for the Finance Manager, Vendor Payment Approval / Payment approver (Operations) and Payment approver (Chief Executive) for the other two.

## "... repeats ... (same vendor, amount and reference). It is blocked until an administrator releases it."

**What happened:** the payment has the same vendor, amount and reference as an earlier one that is not cancelled.

**How to fix it:**

1. Check that it is not a real double payment. If it is, cancel it.

2. If paying again is right, ask an administrator to click **Release Duplicate** (Step 9).
3. Or, if the reference was simply reused by mistake, correct the **Memo** of the draft payment.

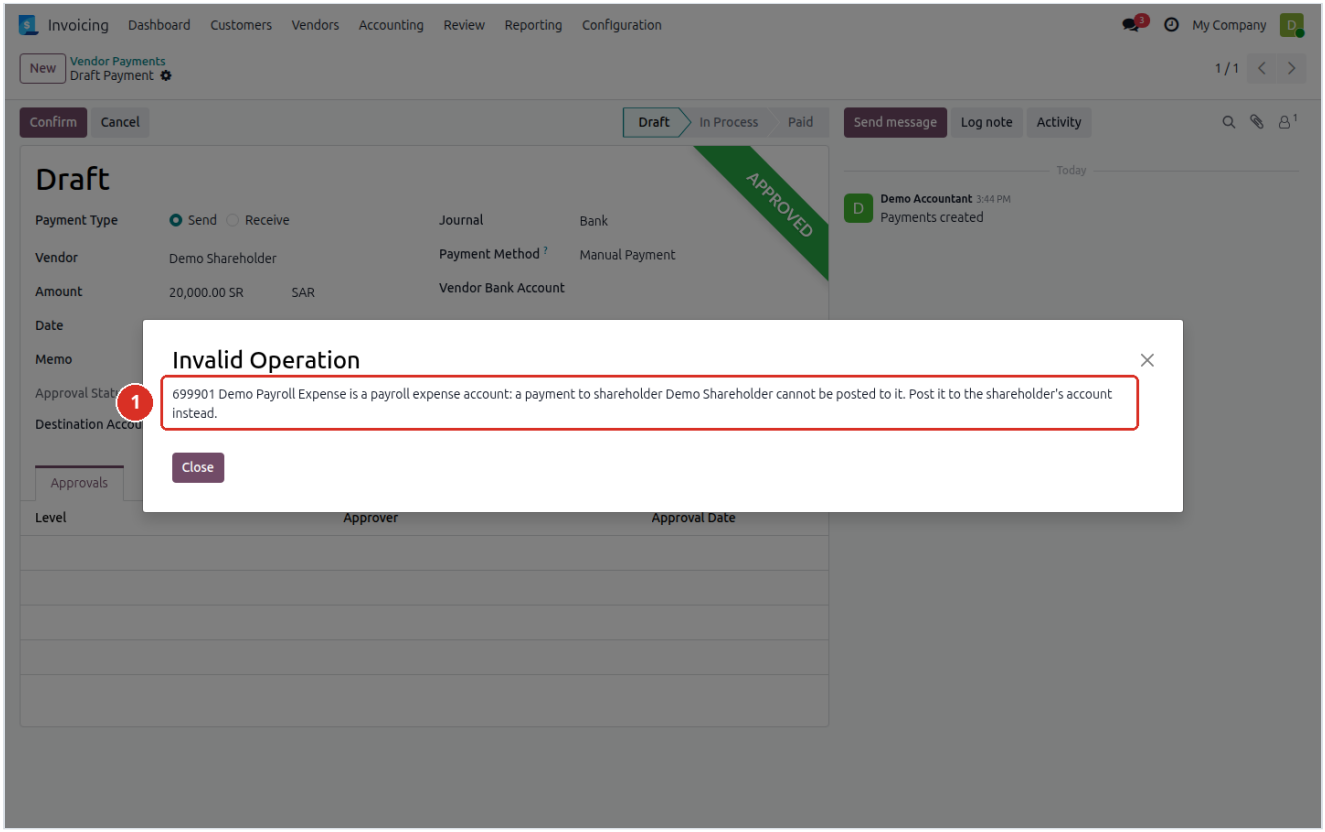
## "Only an administrator can release a duplicate payment."

**What happened:** a user without the Settings right tried to release a duplicate.

**How to fix it:** ask a user with Administration / Settings to release it.

## "... is a payroll expense account: a payment to shareholder ... cannot be posted to it. Post it to the shareholder's account instead."

**What happened:** the payment goes to a contact marked **Shareholder**, and its **Destination Account** is marked **Payroll Expense Account**.




The refusal names the account and the shareholder 1.

**How to fix it:** close the message, set **Destination Account** to the shareholder's own account (for example the shareholder current account), then confirm.

## "The bank account ... of ... is not trusted. Verify it with the vendor and mark it trusted before paying it."

**What happened:** the payment's vendor bank account is not marked **Trusted** in standard Odoo.

**How to fix it:** verify the account details with the vendor through a known channel, then a user allowed to do so marks the bank account as trusted, and you confirm again.

## "Approval thresholds cannot be negative." / "Each approval threshold must be above the one of the level before it."

**What happened:** on the company's **Payment Approval** tab, a threshold is negative, or a set threshold is not higher than the one before it.

**How to fix it:** enter rising amounts (for example 50,000 / 200,000 / 500,000), or 0 for a level you do not use.

## A Finance Manager cannot see Payment Approvals, the Approvals tab or the Destination Account

**What happened:** these are shown only to users of the group Accounting / Bookkeeper (and the two approver groups). Where the full **Accounting** app is installed, Accounting / Administrator includes Bookkeeper. On the demonstration database, where it is not installed, a user with only Accounting / Administrator could still click **Approve** but did not see these three items.

**How to fix it:** install the **Accounting** app, or ask your Odoo partner to give the Finance Manager the Bookkeeper group.

## What this guide does not cover

- The batch payment refusal and the untrusted bank account refusal are described from the module's code and tests; they were not run on screen for this guide.
- Multi-company use was not shown: the demonstration database has one company. Approvals are visible only within the user's companies, and each company has its own thresholds.
- Screenshots were taken as a Finance Manager who also holds the Bookkeeper group, and as the administrator; the approver screens of the Operations Manager and Chief Executive were not captured separately (their approvals appear in Step 7).